

IMPORTANT DATES AND DAYS OF THE YEAR

January

- 9 Pravasi Bhartiya Diwas
- 12 National Youth Day (Birthday of Swami Vivekanand)
- 15 Army Day
- 24 Girl Child Day
- 25 National Tourism Day, Voter's Day
- 26 Indian Republic Day
- 30 Martyr's Day (Mahatma Gandhi's Martyrdom), World Leprosy Eradication Day

February

- 1 Indian Coast Guard Day
- 2 World Wetlands Day
- 28 National Science Day

March

- 3 National Defence Day, World Wildlife Day
- 4 National Security Day
- 8 International Women's Day
- 15 World Consumer Rights Day
- 21 World Forestry Day, International Day for the Elimination of Racial Discrimination
- 22 World Water Day
- 24 World TB Day

April

- 5 National Maritime Day
- 7 World Health Day
- 13 Jallianwala Bagh Massacre Day (1919)
- 14 BR Ambedkar Remembrance Day
- 18 World Heritage Day
- 22 World Earth Day
- 24 Panchayat Divas

May

- 1 International Labour Day (May Day)
- 8 World Red Cross Day
- 21 Anti-Terrorism Day
- 22 World Biodiversity Day
- 31 World Anti-Tobacco Day

June

- 5 World Environment Day
- 20 World Refugee Day
- 21 International Yoga Day

July

- 11 World Population Day

- 26 Kargil Victory Day

- 28 World Nature Conservation Day, World Hepatitis Day

August

- 6 Hiroshima Day (World Peace Day)
- 9 Nagasaki Day
- 15 India's Independence Day
- 20 Sadbhavna Diwas
- 29 National Sports Day (Dhyanchand's birthday)

September

- 5 Teachers' Day, Dr Radhakrishnan's Birthday
- 8 International Literacy Day (UNESCO)
- 15 International Day of Democracy
- 16 World Ozone Day
- 21 International Day of Peace/World Alzheimer's Day
- 27 World Tourism Day

October

- 2 International Non-violence Day, Lal Bahadur Shastri and Mahatma Gandhi's Birthday
- 8 Indian Air Force Day
- 10 World Mental Health Day; National Post Day
- 11 International Girl Child Day
- 20 National Solidarity Day (China attacked India on that day)
- 24 United Nations Day
- 31 Unity Day

November

- 11 National Education Day
- 14 Children's Day, World Diabetes Day
- 16 National Press Day
- 17 National Epilepsy Day
- 19 National Integration Day
- 20 Universal Children's Day (UN)
- 26 Constitution Day

December

- 1 World AIDS Day
- 2 International Day for the Abolition of Slavery
- 3 World Disabled Day
- 4 Navy Day
- 10 Human Rights Day
- 16 Vijay Divas/Bangladesh Day
- 23 Kisan Divas (Farmer's Day)
- 25 National Good Governance Day/X-Mas Day

ABBREVIATIONS

A

AD	Anno Domini (After the birth of Jesus)
AFSPA	Armed Forces Special Power Act
AIDS	Acquired Immuno Deficiency Syndrome
APPLE	Ariane Passenger Payload Experiment
ASI	Archaeological Survey of India
AWACS	Airborne Warning And Control System

B

BC SBI	Banking Codes and Standard Board of India
BBC	British Broadcasting Corporation
BC	Before Christ (Before the birth of Jesus Christ)
BCG	Bacillus Calmette Guerin (Anti-Tuberculosis Vaccine)
BIMSTEC	Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Co-operation
BIS	Bureau of Indian Standards
BMDS	Ballistic Missile Defence System
BRO	Border Roads Organisation
BRT	Bus Rapid Transit

C

CAG	Comptroller and Auditor General
CAIR	Centre for Artificial Intelligence and Robotics
CAZRI	Central Arid Zone Research Institute
CBI	Central Bureau of Investigation
CISF	Central Industrial Security Force
CITES	Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species
CNG	Compressed Natural Gas
CPCB	Central Pollution Control Board
CPRI	Central Power Research Institute
CSIR	Council of Scientific and Industrial Research
CVC	Central Vigilance Commission

D

DDT	Dichlorodiphenyl Trichloroethane
DFDR	Digital Flight Data Recorder (Black Box)
DIG	Deputy Inspector General
DPT	Diphtheria Pertussis Tetanus
DRDO	Defence Research and Development Organisation

E

ECG	Electro Cardiogram
ECT	Electro Convulsive Therapy (electric shock treatment)
EEG	Electro-Encephalography
ELISA	Enzyme Linked Immuno Sorbent Assay (used for testing AIDS)
ESCAP	Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific
EVM	Electronic Voting Machine

F

FDI	Foreign Direct Investment
FII	Foreign Institutional Investor
FERA	Foreign Exchange Regulation Act
FEMA	Foreign Exchange Management Act
FICCI	Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry

G

GATS	General Agreement on Trade in Services
GATT	General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade
GMT	Greenwich Mean Time
GNSS	Global Navigation Satellite System
GPS	Global Positioning System
GSLV	Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle

H

HAL	Hindustan Aeronautics Limited
HIV	Human Immunodeficiency Virus

I

IAAI	International Airport Authority of India
IAEA	International Atomic Energy Agency
ICRC	International Committee of the Red Cross
IMO	International Maritime Organisation
INSAT	Indian National Satellite
IPC	Indian Penal Code
IRBM	Intermediate Range Ballistic Missile
IRS	Indian Remote Sensing Satellite
ISRO	Indian Space Research Organisation

J, K, L

JAM	Jandhan Yojana Aadhar, Mobile Number
KYC	Know Your Customer
LCA	Light Combat Aircraft
LIGO	Laser Interferometer Gravitational wave Observatory
LOC	Line of Control
LOAC	Line of Actual Control
LTA	Light Transport Aircraft

M

MAT	Minimum Alternative Tax
MMS	Multimedia Message Service
MTCR	Missile Technology Control Regime

N

NACO	National AIDS Control Organisation
NAFTA	North American Free Trade Agreement
NASA	National Aeronautics and Space Administration
NATO	North Atlantic Treaty Organisation
NEPA	National Environment Protection Authority
NTPC	National Thermal Power Corporation

O

OCI	Overseas Citizen of India
ODS	Ozone Depletion Substances

P

PIB Press Information Bureau
PSLV Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle

Q, R

RAF Rapid Action Force
RBI Reserve Bank of India
RLV Reusable Launch Vehicle

S

SAFTA South Asian Free Trade Area
SAIL Steel Authority of India Limited
SAPTA SAARC Preferential Trading Agreement
SATNAV Satellite Navigation
SAVE SAARC Audio Visual Exchange
SCO Shanghai Co-operation Organisation
SEBI Securities and Exchange Board of India
SIDBI Small Industries Development Bank of India
STARTS Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty Station

T

TIN Tax Identification Number
TIEA Tax Information Exchange Agreement

TRAI Telecom Regulatory Authority of India
TRIPS Trade Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights

U

UAV Unmanned Aerial Vehicle
UNCTAD United Nations Conference on Trade and Development
UNDP United Nations Development Programme
UNEP United Nations Environment Programme
UNFPA United Nations Fund for Population Activities

V

VAT Value Added Tax
VOIP Voice Over Internet Protocol

W

WADA World Anti-Doping Agency
WFP World Food Programme
WWF World Wide Fund for Nature

X, Y, Z

YAHOO Yet Another Hierarchical Official Oracle
ZSI Zoological Survey of India

AWARDS AND HONOURS

INTERNATIONAL AWARDS AND HONOURS

Nobel Prize

- The Nobel prizes are given under the will of Alfred Bernhard Nobel, who died in 1896.
- Nobel prizes are given each year in the six fields. The Nobel prizes for Peace, Physics, Chemistry, Medicine and Literature were started in 1901. The Nobel Prize for Economics was started in 1968.
- The awards are presented in Stockholm in an annual ceremony on 10th December, except the Peace Prize, which is awarded in Oslo, Norway.
- The prize is not awarded posthumously; however, if a person is awarded a prize and dies before receiving it, the prize may still be presented.

Indian Nobel Laureates

Name	Field	Year
Rabindranath Tagore	Literature (Gitanjali)	1913
CV Raman	Physics (Raman Effect)	1930
Hargobind Khorana (of Indian Descent)	Medicine (Genetic Code)	1968
Mother Teresa	Peace	1979
Subramanian Chandrashekar (of Indian Descent)	Physics (Chandrashekar's Limit)	1983
Amartya Sen	Economics (Welfare Economics)	1998
Sir VS Naipaul (of Indian Descent)	Literature	2001
Venkatraman Ramakrishnan (of Indian Descent)	Chemistry (Ribosomes)	2009
Kailash Satyarthi (with Malala Yousafzai of Pakistan)	Peace	2014

Ramon Magsaysay Award

- Ramon Magsaysay Award is an annual award given in memory of former Philippine President Ramon Magsaysay. Basic objective of award is to perpetuate the former President exemplary integrity in governance, courageous service to the people and ideal decision-making in democratic society.
- Award is given by Ramon Magsaysay award foundation to only Asian individuals. Since its inception in 1958, award were given in six different categories viz Government service, public service, community leadership, journalism, literature and creative communication arts, peace and international understanding and emergent leadership. But, from 2009 onwards awards are given for emergent leadership or in uncategorised category.
- Vinoba Bhave was first Indian to receive Magsaysay Award.

Pulitzer Prize

- Pulitzer Prize is an award for achievements in newspaper, magazine and online journalism, literature and musical composition in the United States.
- It was established in 1917 by provisions in the will of American (Hungarian-born) Joseph Pulitzer, who had made his fortune as a newspaper publisher. Award is administered by Columbia University in New York City.
- The winner in the public service category of the journalism competition is awarded a gold medal, while other gets a certificate and US \$ 10000 cash award.

Indians Who have Won Pulitzer Prize

Gobind Behari Lal (for reporting)	1937
Jhumpa Lahiri (Interpreter of Maladies) for Fiction	2000
Geeta Anand (for journalism)	2003
Dr Siddhartha Mukherjee (for Non-Fiction) (The Emperor of all Maladies: A Biography of Cancer)	2011
Vijay Seshadri (Poem)	2014

Man Booker Prize

The name of Booker Prize has been renamed as **Man Booker Prize** in 2002, reflecting the sponsorship by an investment of company, The Man Group PLC. The award is given each year, it is an international literary award hosted in Britain.

Import Facts about Man Booker Prize

Awarded for	Best full-length English novel
Presented by	Man Group
Country	Commonwealth of Nations, Ireland and Zimbabwe
Prize Money	50000 pound
First Awarded	1969
Recent	George Saunders for his fiction Lincon in the Bardo (2017)

Indians Who have Won Winner of Man Booker Prize

VS Naipaul (Novel-In a Free State)	1971
Salman Rushdie (Novel-Midnight Children)	1981
Rohinton Mistry (Such a Long Journey)	1991
Arundhati Roy (Novel-The God of Small Things)	1997
Kiran Desai (Novel-The Inheritance of Loss)	2006
Aravind Adiga (Novel- The White Tiger)	2008

Man Booker International Prize

Man Booker International Prize is an International Literary Award. Earlier award was given biennially now it is being given annually. Albanian novelist Ismail Kadare was named the first winner in 2005. An author can win this award only once.

Important Facts About this Award

Awarded for	Best English (or Available for Translation into English Fiction)
Presented by	Man Group
Country	Any Nationality
Cash Award	60000 Pounds
First Awarded	2005

Film, Music and Art Awards

Oscar Award

The Academy Awards informally known as the Oscar, are a set of awards given annually for excellence in cinematic achievement. It is organised and overseen by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Science (AMPAS) of United States.

Important Facts About the Oscar Award

Founder	Margaret Hareke on behalf of its first father Herman Oscar.
Nature of Prize	Citation (Academy Award for Merit)
5 Spikes-Designate	For Producer, Writer, Director, Actor and Technician

Some Important Facts Related to Oscar

Only person, who won both Oscar Prize as well as Nobel Prize	George Bernard Shaw (Ireland)
Titanic (1997), Ben-Hur (1959) and The Lord of the Rings : The Return of the King (2003) these three films have won	11 Oscars
Most nominations for Oscar	Walt Disney (59 times), John Williams (50 times)
Youngest to get Oscar Prize	Tatum O Neil (Paper Moon), 10 years
First Posthumously Nominated Actor	James Dean (2 Times)
Oldest to get nominated	Gloria Stuart (87 years) (California)
First film to win Oscar	Wings 1927-28 directed by William A Wellman, a silent movie

Indians Who have Won Oscar Awards

Name	Category	Year
Bhanu Athaiya	Costume Design (Gandhi) (First Indian who won Oscar)	1982
Satyajit Ray	Lifetime Achievement Award	1992
AR Rahman	Best original score and best original song (Slumdog Millionaire)	2009
Gulzar	Best original song (Slumdog Millionaire)	2009
Resul Pookutty	Best sound mixing (Slumdog Millionaire)	2009
Rahul Thakkar (Indian-American)	Dream Works Animation Media Review System (Sci-Tech. Award)	2016
Cottalango Leon (Indian-American)	Sony Pictures Image Works (Sci-Tech. Award)	2016

Grammy Awards

A Grammy award or Grammy, is an honor awarded by the recording academy to recognise outstanding achievement in the mainly English-language music industry.

Important Facts About the Grammy Award

Presented by	National Academy of Recording Arts and Sciences of the United States
First Awarded	1959
Categories	108
Award Description	The Gold-Plated trophies, each depicting a gilded gramophone. They are made and assembled by hand by Billings Artworks in Ridgway, Colorado

Indians Who have Won Grammy Award

Name	Year
Pandit Ravi Shankar (5 Grammy Awards)	1967, 1973, 2002, 2013 and Lifetime Achievement Award received at the 55th Annual Grammy Awards
Zakir Hussain (2 times)	1992, 2009
Vishwa Mohan Bhatt	1994
Vikku Vinayak	1991
AR Rahman	2009
PA Deepak	2010
Rickey Kej	2015

International Beauty Contest

Miss Universe

Formation	1952, Founded by-California Clothing Company, Pacific Mills
Headquarters	New York City, United States
Slogan	Redefined for Today
Indian Winners	(a) Sushmita Sen (1994) (b) Lara Dutta (2000)
Cash prize	US \$ 70000

Miss World

Formation	In 1951, By Eric Morley, UK (It is the oldest surviving major international beauty pageant)
Headquarters	London, England
Official Language	English
Slogan	Beauty with a Purpose
Indian Winners	(a) Reita Faria (1966) (First Asian Winner) (b) Aishwarya Rai (1994) (c) Diana Hayden (1997) (d) Yukta Mookhey (1999) (e) Priyanka Chopra (2000) (f) Manushi Chhillar (2017)
Cash prize	50000 British pound

Miss Earth

Motto	Beauties for a Cause
Formation	In 2001
Headquarters	Philippines
Indian Winner (2010)	Nicole Faria

Miss India

Formation	1963, Organised by Femina, a women's magazine published by Bennett, Coleman and Company Limited
Headquarters	Mumbai, India

INDIAN AWARDS AND HONOURS

India's International Awards

International Gandhi Peace Prize

- It was instituted in 1995 by Government of India to encourage and promote Gandhian values world wide.
- The award carries ₹ 10 million in cash, convertible in any currency in the world, a plaque and citation. It is open to all persons regardless of nationality, race, creed or sex.
- The Peace Prize is awarded annually by the Government of India. The Award is given to individual and institutions for their contribution towards social, economic and political transformation through non-violence and other Gandhian methods.
- The Jury consists of Prime Minister of India, Leader of opposition in the Lok Sabha, Chief Justice of India and two other eminent personalities.
- In 2014, ISRO was awarded International Gandhi Peace Prize.

Indira Gandhi Prize

- It is also known as Indira Gandhi Peace Prize or the Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development. It was instituted in 1986 and awarded by Indira Gandhi Memorial Trust.